While these techniques are useful, none allow you to evolve the schema of the database.

New tables, new constraints, new data relationships, and new indexes are common ways that applications evolve as developers add more features or improve the data model over time. While schema evolution happens locally during the development cycle, it's not always practical to populate huge amounts of data in local databases.

Your staging environment or even a dedicated performance testing environment helps you analyze and test performance problems and allows you to safely modify the structure when needed. Wouldn't it be nice to have a performance database to test on? How might you set that up?

In the next chapter you'll set up a Performance testing database where you can make these kinds of changes. You'll build up a Performance database by starting from the Rideshare database and making it safe to use.

Let's get started!